

Fear of Missing Out (FOMO) & Internet Addiction

A Self-Check Worksheet

Do I Experience FOMO?

Check all the statements that sound like you:

- ☐ I feel anxious when I can't check my phone.
- ☐ I check social media often to see what others are doing.
- ☐ I feel left out when I see friends hanging out without me online.
- ☐ I compare my life to what I see online.
- ☐ I feel pressure to reply to messages immediately.
- ☐ I worry I'll miss something important if I log off.
- ☐ I post things mainly so others know I'm doing something cool.

If you checked 3 or more, the fear of missing out (FOMO) might be influencing your screen habits.

What Does FOMO Feel Like for You?

1. What do you usually see online that triggers FOMO?
(e.g., group hangouts, vacations, fun events)

2. What emotion do you feel most when you experience FOMO?

Sad

Jealous

Anxious

Left out

Pressured

Other: _____

3. What do you usually do when that feeling shows up?
(e.g., keep scrolling, post something, text friends)

Your FOMO Patterns

Example

Situation	What You Saw	How You Felt	What You Did
Friday night	Friends at a party	Angry, sad	Scrolled for 3 hours

Now write about what you experience

Situation	What You Saw	How You Felt	What You Did

Take Back Control

Check the strategies you'd like to try this week:

- ☐ Remind myself social media only shows the highlights
- ☐ Take 30 minutes a day offline, no notifications
- ☐ Talk to a friend in real life instead of just texting
- ☐ Keep a gratitude list (what's good in my life)
- ☐ Have 1 screen-free hour each evening
- ☐ Mute accounts that trigger FOMO or comparison

Final Thoughts!

Finish the sentence:

When I stop comparing myself online, I feel more _____